Call Review: 1 to 15 October

What my own Close calls say about authority, the why, and the objections that keep coming up. Read it alongside the VSL script (library/vsl-script-freeman.md).

The short version

I went through every completed call in Close from 1 to 15 October, about 490 of them. Calls before 1 October have no transcripts, so they're not included. Most were voicemails and quick "call me later"s. Around 45 were real conversations of four minutes or more: first quals, check-ins before Freeman's call, and follow-ups after it.

The structure is there: work, location, funds, credit, the video, booking, Meet link, a check-in. What's missing is depth. Too often I'm ticking the box and moving on, when the lead has just handed me the reason they'll buy.

The five changes that would make the biggest difference:

1. **Stop answering the why for them.** "I'm guessing you want to buy your time back and spend it with people you value, is that right?" came up on 10 calls. Every time, the lead just said "yeah". That's my why, not theirs.
2. **Stop accepting the vague answer.** "No target", "not in a hurry", "just want to learn", "freedom". Each one got "makes sense" or "I love that". Each one should get a follow-up.
3. **When they hand me pain, stop.** "Barely surviving." "My back's hurting." "Always stressed." "Don't want to wait till 2028." I said "I get that" and asked about work. That pain is what the call is for.
4. **Zero prices, zero instalments.** I quoted a figure on at least 13 calls and offered to split payments on three. Wilson's wife vetoed the price before Freeman ever spoke. Chris asked for a price, got one, and went with someone else.
5. **I set the next step, not them.** "I'll text you when I'm ready." "I'll phone you next week." "No worries." Every call ends with a day and time that I chose.

What I already do well (keep it)

- **The one rule and the trailer.** "Not a consultation, not a chit-chat" and "my one rule: watch the video" (Justin, Peter, Stanley, Mary, Daniel E, Shola). Freeman wants this on every call.
- **Why a mentor, not YouTube.** I asked it on Chris, Halimat, Praise and Justin, and got real answers ("free stuff hides the hard parts").
- **Firm voicemails.** "If I don't hear back before the call, we'll have to cancel it" (Ejiro, Peter, Kingsley). That's authority.
- **Moving calls for the partner.** I moved Wilson's call to 6pm so his wife could join. That's the standard.
- **Some brilliant dig questions.** To Daniel Y: "What stopped you starting properly before? Why is now different? I want to be sure that if Freeman puts his time into you, it gets you to your goals." To Matthew: "If you were able to start, what would need to be in place for you to prioritise this?" To Issah: "Why now rather than in a year?" To Praise: "Why not settle with the two extra streams you've got?"
- **Explaining Management.** The £4k minus £2k example works. Leads get it.
- **Handling credit.** I handled Ameer's credit well, and Freeman closed him.
- **Using the cost of waiting.** To Wilson: "I wouldn't want you to keep waiting and it ends up being a year with no progress." To Augustine: "You said January, but getting prepared before the winter months is essential."

1. Authority

Authority isn't being pushy. It's the frame you set at the start, a standard you hold, and being willing to let someone go.

What's costing me

What I did	What happened	Do instead
Asked "alone or with a partner?" with no frame (Anthony)	"You want unnecessary information… I don't have time for this nonsense." Hung up.	Set the interview frame first (script, step 2). Then personal questions feel like part of the process, not nosiness.
"I'm quite busy today, can we talk next week?" to fresh applicants (11 Oct)	Speed to lead lost, and it tells them they're not a priority	A fresh app is the priority. If I truly can't talk, I book a time today.
"Sorry if I've disturbed you" (Aminat)	Apologising for calling someone who applied	"You applied to work with Freeman, so I'm calling to see if you're a fit."
Missed callbacks: Chris, Justin, Ifeyinwa, Ejiro, Daniel N	Chris went with a competitor. Justin opened with "I said call me by 4 yesterday."	Every agreed callback goes in Close as a task with a time. I never miss one.
Leads asking "Is this Freeman?" (Oluwabunmi, Wilson)	They don't know who they're speaking to	"I work alongside Freeman, so I'm not him" on every opener.
The lead sets the next step: Erich ("I'll phone you next week"), Reece ("I'll text you when I'm ready"), Oladimeji, Moo, Khadijah	"Perfect" / "No worries", then nothing	"I'd rather lock a time in so I'm not chasing you. Tuesday 6pm or Wednesday morning?"
Hype instead of a standard: "You and Freeman will click", "He'll take a real liking to you" (Kenzie, Saheed)	Kenzie got to Freeman unmotivated and expecting a price	Save the hype. Replay their why instead: "You want X because Y. How excited are you for Thursday?"
Reassuring before asking: Marshall said his area was remote, and I said "location isn't too big a factor"	The objection was never really found out	"What makes you think that?" first. Then answer.
Check-ins that let calls go ahead without the partner (Stella, Issah, Adetitun, Justin)	Stella's husband had already said "put it on hold". She was lost on the Freeman call.	No partner, no Freeman slot. Move the call to when both can be there.

Authority isn't chasing

Gina said this to me on 5 October, and it's worth reading twice:

> “I don't like to channel my life around people… when you start sending me messages to remind me, call me to check if I've watched… that's when people lose me. She pushed too hard.”

Pressure (reminder after reminder, chasing texts, "just checking in") feels like authority, but it's the opposite. It tells the lead we need them. Real authority:

- **Set the frame once, at the start.** "You applied, my job is to see if you're a fit."
- **Get them to commit to their own time.** "When can you watch it?" Then one check-in at that time. Not five texts.
- **Be willing to let them go.** "If now's not the right time, that's OK. I'd rather you come back when it is."

Lines to use

When they ask "just tell me how to get started":

> “That's exactly what Freeman maps out with you on the call. My job right now is to check you're a fit, because he only takes on people he's sure he can get results for. Five minutes, fair?”

When they say "I'll call you":

> “I appreciate that. I'd rather lock it in, though, so I'm not chasing you and you're not chasing me. Tuesday at 6 or Wednesday at 10?”

When they're half-in (Gina, Moo):

> “Honestly, if now's not the right time, that's completely fine. I'd rather you come back when you're ready than force it. What would ready look like for you?”

2. The why: from tick boxes to pain

I'm answering for them

On 10 first quals I gave the lead their own why and asked them to agree. Word for word:

> “I'm guessing your main goal is to buy your time back and spend it with those who you value most, is that right?”

Every time, the answer was "Yeah."

That happened with Gloria, Halimat, Issah, Abbie, Adetitun, Loretta, Ipaye, Justin, Tunrayo and Andrew. None of them said anything I could use. Freeman can't close someone on "yeah".

> **Don't**
> Never put words in their mouth. Ask the open question, then shut up and count to five in my head. Silence is where the real answer comes out.

I'm accepting the vague answer

They said	I said	Ask instead
Kenzie: "Not really" (to a target by March)	"No worries, everybody looks into it differently"	"If you were sat in a job interview, you wouldn't say 'not really'. Six months from now, what do you want to have?"
Abbie: "Not in a hurry, just want to understand it"	"Always good to not rush into anything"	"What's made you apply now, then, if there's no rush?"
Issah: "Just break even, not lose money"	"Perfect, that sounds good"	"Breaking even isn't a goal, it's not losing. What would actually excite you?"
Obinna: "I just want to learn it, for when I have the money"	"I like that approach"	"Learn it so you can do what? People don't invest in a mentor just to learn."
Halimat: "Financially stable, more time with family" (dodged a number)	"That's a mature approach"	"What does stable look like in numbers? What would you stop worrying about?"
Tunrayo: "No expectation, just get into it slow"	"I totally get it, resonates with most people"	"Slow is fine. But you're doing 12 to 15-hour shifts. How long can you keep that up?"
Shola: "I don't look at the money first"	"I love that mentality"	"Respect that. So what are you looking at first? What would make this a success for you?"
Abbie: "Financially stable, be free, freedom"	"Mm, okay, no problem"	"Free from what, exactly?"
Justin: "Saw Freeman talk about passive income"	Moved on	"What does passive mean to you? It's a business, it takes work at the start."
Alomgir: "Just make some money, brother"	"Fair enough"	"How much, exactly? And what would that money change?"
Daniel Y: "Revisit it, stay consistent" (after my great 'why is now different?')	"I like that, we want action takers", then booked	"That sounds like what you said last time. What's actually going to be different?"

The gold they handed me, and I walked past

Lead	What they said	What I did	What to ask
Daniel E (8 Oct)	"I've got a family, I'd love to give them a good life… working every day and still can't achieve anything tangible. Just barely surviving."	"No, yeah, I get that. Totally." Then: what do you do for work?	"Barely surviving. What does that look like day to day?" → "How long has it felt like that?" → "What would it mean for your family if this worked?"
Chikezie (13 Oct)	"This country, busy all the time… the stress… my back, everywhere is telling me."	"If it's not a priority, we'll talk in the New Year."	"Your back's telling you something. Is that why you applied? If nothing changes, next Christmas is the same, isn't it?"
Loretta (12 Oct)	Four years in the UK, hard to manage family and work, child starting college next year, rota 10am to 8am the next day	"So investing in a mentorship wouldn't make sense right now, is that correct?" (I handed her the objection)	"College is next year. If you wait until after the house, where do the fees come from?"
Dorcas (3 Oct)	"Time, because I'm always stressed."	Asked at minute 4 of her 10-minute break. She left: "When I'm ready, I'll reach out."	Ask the why first, logistics later. "Always stressed. What's a normal week like for you?"
Onyeiwu (9 Oct)	"I don't want to wait till 2028, stuck in one job."	Moved on to visa and mortgages	"What happens in 2028? What's it like being stuck right now?"
Marshall (9 Oct)	"Relief from a stressful job"	Line dropped. On the second call: "What role?" "Working somewhere." Then straight to booking.	"What makes it stressful? How long have you been carrying that?"
Adetitun (12 Oct)	"I'm in a phase of my life where I want more." Husband worried about winter and empty nights.	Led her ("spend time with your girls?"). The husband's worry was never handled.	"More of what, exactly?" → "What did your husband say, word for word? If that was answered, would he be in?"
Praise (13 Oct)	"My time is very limited."	"I love that, man."	"Limited how? What are you missing because of it?"
Irena (14 Oct)	Debts, seven months on sick pay, "studied it for years, no results"	Accepted "freedom", then "talk in a couple of months"	"Years of studying and no results. What's been missing? What would this year look like if it worked?"
Ipaye, Stella	"Easier said than done."	Moved on	"Which part feels hardest?" Then answer that one part.

Lead	What they said	What I did	What to ask
Adekunle (6 Oct)	"My interest cooled down a bit."	Asked once, got silence, resent the video	"When you applied, something made you fill that in. What was going on then? Has that changed?"

The pain ladder

Every why answer has three levels. **Don't move on to money until I've heard level 3 in their own words.**

1. **The fact.** "I work 12-hour shifts." "I want extra income." (This is where I usually stop.)
2. **The cost.** "What's that costing you?" "What does that look like day to day?" "Who else does it affect?"
3. **The feeling and the stakes.** "How long have you felt like that?" "How does that make you feel?" "What happens if you're in the same spot this time next year?"

Example (Daniel E, how it should have gone):

- **Daniel:** "Working every day and still can't achieve anything tangible. Just barely surviving."
- **Me:** "Barely surviving. What does that actually look like, day to day?"
- **Daniel:** [the real answer: bills, overtime, missing the kids]
- **Me:** "How long has it been like that?"
- **Daniel:** [years]
- **Me:** "And if nothing changes, where are you this time next year?"
- **Me:** "So you want [goal] because you're tired of [pain], and it has to be now because [reason]. Have I got that right?"

Then **write their exact words** in the Close note. Freeman uses them on his call.

Ask the why early

Dorcas had a ten-minute break, and I spent it on the video and money. If they've only got five minutes, ask the why first and book the rest. Funds and location take thirty seconds on the next call. The why is what decides if there is a next call.

3. The objections that keep coming up

Ranked by how often I heard them. The full scripts are in the VSL script under **Extra 3: the objections that keep coming up**.

#	Objection	Heard from	What I did	The fix
1	"How much is it?" / "Just tell me the price"	Gloria, Alomgir, Chris, Halimat, Kenzie, Adetitun, Peter, Brendan, Wilson, Ameer, Ajaratu, Andrew, Charles, Tina, Elisus	Quoted it: "maximum 3K all in", "low four figures", "2.5 to 3k", "6 to 8k with the mentorship"	Never a number. "Built around your situation. Freeman goes through it on the call. If it made sense, would you want to do it?"

#	Objection	Heard from	What I did	The fix
2	"Not ready" / "When I'm ready I'll reach out"	Moo (said the same in April), Oladimeji, Tina, Dorcas, Gloria, Khadijah, Obinna, Shad, Emeka, Matthew	"No problem, take care"	"What does ready look like?" → "When will that be in place?" → "What's waiting costing you?" → a date I set
3	"I need to speak to my partner" / "My partner said no"	Stella, Wilson, Adetitun, Justin, Issah, Tina, Brendan, Gina	Let the Freeman call go ahead without them, or pitched Management as the cheaper option	"What exactly did they say?" → "If that was answered, would they be in?" → book them onto Freeman's call
4	"I'm busy" / "Bad time of year" / "Next week"	Chikezie, Natalie, Pierre, Echezona, Erich, Brandon, Precious	"Talk in the New Year"	Extra 2 in the script (the time objection). Always ends with a booked time.
5	"Can I pay in instalments?" / "Is there any wiggle room?"	Stella, Peter, Ajaratu, Saheed	Offered to split it in two or three, and said I'd ask Freeman for wiggle room	Never offer it. "That's one for Freeman. If the numbers worked, are you in?"
6	"Is this a scam?" / "The advert said it was free"	Marshall, Elisus	"That's exactly why we want you on the call"	"I'd be careful too. What would you need to see?" The training is free; working with Freeman is paid.
7	"I'm looking at other mentors"	Wilson (a masterclass), Chris (a done-for-you company)	Didn't ask about it, or wished them well	"Good, you should compare. What did you like about them? What's stopping you going with them?"
8	"My interest has cooled" / "The excitement's gone"	Adekunle, Victory	Resent the video	Go back to the moment they applied
9	"Easier said than done"	Stella, Ipaye	Moved on	"Which part feels hardest?"
10	"My area isn't good for Airbnb" / "The videos are all London"	Marshall, Shola, Stanley (Scotland)	Reassured straight away	"What makes you think that?" first. Scotland: Management only.
11	"I don't want to use credit" / worried about interest	Andrew, Wilson, Daniel E, Abbie	"Freeman says it's good to use credit"	Respect it. Confirm the cash figure and move on. Never push credit.

#	Objection	Heard from	What I did	The fix
12	Visa / sponsorship	Onyeiwu, Gladys, Precious	"Freeman's had a few people on sponsorship, it may not be an issue"	Don't guess. "Good question. Freeman will go through that with you on the call."

Price is the big one

Price came up more than anything else, and every time I gave a number it cost us:

- **Wilson.** He asked for the price on the first call, and I gave him a range plus "use a credit card, pay monthly". The next day his wife said they weren't "in a place to pay for mentorship of that much". Freeman never got to speak to her.
- **Chris.** I missed his callback, then gave a price when he asked. He said he had no time for "another introductory call" and went with someone else.
- **Tina.** "Training alone is £3,000, so where do we get the funds for the business?" The number started the objection.
- **Ajaratu.** A good why ("the best time to start was yesterday"), then a price plus "split in two". Now she's waiting until January.

A number on my call gets judged with no value behind it. On Freeman's call it lands after he's built the plan. That's why it's his card, not mine.

4. Check-in calls: receptionist or interviewer?

- **Me:** "Did you watch the video?" **Halimat:** "Yeah."
- **Me:** "How did you find it?" **Halimat:** "It was... okay."
- **Me:** "Perfect."

"Okay" is a red flag, not a "perfect". Halimat then joined Freeman's call from a hair salon. The same thing happened with Kenzie ("knew most of it anyway"), Daniel E ("virtually everything stood out") and Dorcas ("so far, so good").

On every check-in, ask at least three of the proof questions from the script (Call 2), and **ask the why again**. "Since we last spoke, why do you still want to do this?" If they can't explain the model back to me or tell me why they're doing it, Freeman's call moves.

5. Lines to stop saying

Don't
Any price or range: "maximum 3K", "low four figures", "2.5 to 3k", "6 to 8k with the mentorship". Not even "it's nowhere near 10 grand".

Don't
"He's flexible with payments", "split into two or three", "I'll see if there's wiggle room", "use a credit card and pay monthly".

Don't
"It's only profit with management" or "700 to 2k per property". These are income claims. Use their own goal number instead.

Don't
"Freeman's had people on sponsorship, it may not be an issue." Don't guess on visas. Say it's one for Freeman.

Don't
"Freeman's had 30-odd mentees, 30+ properties in 18 months." Unless Freeman has confirmed it, don't quote it.

Don't
"Sorry if I've disturbed you." "I'm quite busy today." "No worries, no stress" (as the end of the call).

Don't
"I'm guessing your main goal is to buy your time back… is that right?"

6. This week's drills

1. **Before every dial:** write down one word from their Q6 answer, and ask about that word.
2. **After every first qual:** write the one-line why in the Close note. "[Name] wants [goal] because [pain], and it has to be now because [reason]." If I can't write it, they don't get a Freeman slot.
3. **Count to five** after every why answer before I speak.
4. **No numbers for a week.** Every time someone asks the price, use the Extra 3 line and tick it off. Count how many still book.
5. **Every call ends with a time I chose.** Never "I'll call you" from them.
6. **Every callback is a Close task with a time.** Zero missed.
7. **One recorded call a day, played back.** Listen for: did I lead the why? Did I accept a vague answer? Did I hear level 3?